SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

1 September 2023 · Shift 1

48 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 42 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

General Awareness 23 questions

Q.1

FIFA U-17 Women's World Cup 2022 matches were NOT held in which state?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Odisha
(C) Goa
(D) Gujarat

Q.2

Who among the following is one of the co-authors of the book, ‘Cracking The Code:My Journey in Bollywood’?

(A) Harshvardhan Kapoor
(B) Nawazuddin Siddique
(C) Ayushmann Khurrana
(D) Rajkumar Rao

Q.3

In 1873, who published the first photograph of nerve tissue stained with the black reaction technique, describing a whole nerve cell?

(A) Gunter Blobel
(B) Camillo Golgi
(C) William Harvey
(D) Paul Ehrlich

Q.4

In October 2022, Virat Kohli became the first Indian to complete how many runs in T20 cricket history?

(A) 11000
(B) 9000
(C) 5000
(D) 15000

Q.5

According to Sikh literature, the birth anniversary of Guru Nanak Dev is celebrated on the full moon day of the Indian lunar month _____.

(A) Magh
(B) Paush
(C) Ashada
(D) Kartik

Q.6

Yakshagana is a folk dance that belongs to the state of _____.

(A) Kerala
(B) Karnataka
(C) Haryana
(D) Rajasthan

Q.7

The brick temple of Bhitargaon is situated in which state?

(A) Odisha
(B) Jharkhand
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.8
Which of the following movements was founded in Bengal?

(A) Ramakrishna Mission
(B) Arya Samaj
(C) Satyashodhak Samaj
(D) Prarthana Samaj

Q.9
On 15 August 1947, the first prime minister of India, Jawaharlal Nehru, raised the Indian National Flag above the _____of Red Fort in Delhi.

(A) Delhi Gate
(B) Kashmiri Gate
(C) Ajmeri Gate
(D) Lahori Gate

Q.10
'Mandarin' is the official language of which neighbouring country of India?

(A) Afghanistan
(B) Bhutan
(C) Sri Lanka
(D) China

Q.11
Which of the following is used to measure the total output of goods and services in an economy including depreciation during a specific period within country?

(A) Net Domestic Product (NDP)
(B) Gross National Product (GNP)
(C) Net National Product (NNP)
(D) Gross Domestic Product (GDP)

Q.12
Which of the following is NOT related to the sport of swimming?

(A) Breaststroke
(B) Back stroke
(C) Freestyle
(D) Penalty Corner

Q.13
The East-West corridor, which is a part of the Golden Quadrilateral super highways, links which two cities of India from the following?

(A) Ahmadnagar and Imphal
(B) Silchar and Porbander
(C) Jaipur and Gangtok
(D) Gandhi Nagar and Silchar

Q.14
What is the name of the seventh most abundant metal in the earth's crust, which is derived from the medieval Latin word 'Kalium'?

(A) Aluminium
(B) Magnesium
(C) Calcium
(D) Potassium

Q.15
What is the aim of Article 44 of the Indian Constitution?

(A) To protect every monument or place of artistic or historic interest
(B) To separate judiciary from the executive in the public services of the State
(C) To protect and improve the environment and safeguard the forests and wildlife of the country
(D) To secure for the citizen, a uniform civil code through the territory of India

Q.16
Which of the following novels of Kamleshwar was awarded the Sahitya Akademi Award in 2003?

(A) Jalti Hui Nadi
(B) Kaali Aandhi
(C) Kitne Pakistan
(D) Ek Sadak Sattavan Galiyan

Q.17
Which of the following institutes was founded by MG Ranade and GV Joshi?

(A) Abhinav Bharat
(B) The Indian National Congress
(C) The Bombay Presidency Association
(D) Poona Sarvajanik Sabha

Q.18
Roshan Kumari, Shovana Narayan, Maya Rao and Kumudini Lakhia are eminent _____ artists.

(A) Odissi
(B) Kuchipudi
(C) Kathak
(D) Manipuri

Q.20
What is the difference between a debit card and a credit card?

(A) Debit cards are used for online transactions, while credit cards are used for in-person purchases.
(B) Credit cards require a PIN, while debit cards require a signature.
(C) Debit cards withdraw money directly from a bank account, while credit cards allow borrowing up to a certain limit.
(D) Debit cards have higher interest rates than credit cards.

Q.21
The Constitution (Scheduled Tribes) Order (Second Amendment) Bill, 2022 has included Narikoravan and Kurivikkaran communities in the list of Scheduled Tribes of which state?

(A) Bihar
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Chhattisgarh
(D) Odisha

Q.23
Which river is also known as Tsangpo?

(A) Ganga river
(B) Gandak river
(C) Kaveri river
(D) Brahmaputra river

Q.24
What is the destination of the water drained off by the Nile river?

(A) Lake Victoria
(B) Indian Ocean
(C) Mediterranean Sea
(D) Lake Tanganyika

Q.25
Article 149 of the Constitution deals with _____.

(A) the qualifications required for the appointment of the Comptroller and Auditor-General of India
(B) the duties and powers of the Comptroller and Auditor-General of India
(C) the term of office of the Comptroller and Auditor-General of India
(D) the appointment of the Comptroller and Auditor-General of India

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Feud

(A) Gross
(B) Peril
(C) Harmony
(D) Vigour

Q.2

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. All these things happen/ because she do not / pay heed to my words.

(A) pay heed to my words
(B) All these things happen
(C) No error
(D) because she do not

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Professor said that “I will be late for the lecture”.

(A) he shall be late for the lecture
(B) he is late for the lecture
(C) he would be late for the lecture
(D) he may be late for the lecture

Q.4

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Separate
(B) Accommodate
(C) Definitely
(D) Embarass

Q.5

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Sell like hot cakes

(A) Quick sell out
(B) Selling cakes
(C) Being ignored
(D) Eating hot cake

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Andrew “will playing” basketball at the college tournament.

(A) are play the
(B) are play
(C) is playing
(D) is played

Q.7

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. Hardik Pandya hit four _____ fours and scored 72 runs in the match.

(A) continuous
(B) consecutive
(C) ongoing
(D) constant

Q.8

Select the sentence that has NO spelling errors.

(A) The doctor presribed some medicine to alleviate my parsistent cough, which has been boathering me for days.
(B) The doctor precribed some medicine to aleviate my persistent cough, which has been bothering me for days.
(C) The doctor prescribed some medicine to aleviate my parsistent cough, which has been boathering me for days.
(D) The doctor prescribed some medicine to alleviate my persistent cough, which has been bothering me for days.

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the bracketed word in the following sentence to fill in the blank. The athlete’s perseverance and mental toughness _____(facilitate) her to overcome adversity and achieve her goals.

(A) restricted
(B) enabled
(C) limited
(D) hindered

Q.10

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Throughout my career as a journalist, / I covered many important stories and / interviewed numerous individuals, which allow me / to share important information and insights with my readers.

(A) to share important information and insights with my readers

(B) I covered many important stories and

(C) Throughout my career as a journalist,

(D) interviewed numerous individuals, which allow me

Q.11

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Harish says / that his sister / loves to play / harmonium.

(A) harmonium

(B) loves to play

(C) Harish says

(D) that his sister

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the following sentence. Selling, purchasing, and using “an illegally copied” product is a criminal offence.

(A) an obsolete

(B) a pirated

(C) an outlawed

(D) a crooked

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The hiring manager has already offered you the job; now, _____ to accept or decline the offer.

(A) a penny for your thoughts

(B) the ball is in your court

(C) pull your leg

(D) get your act together

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Oberon doesn’t like the way Demetrius _____ to Helena. (Credit: A Midsummer Night’s Dream)

(A) talked

(B) talks

(C) talking

(D) to talk

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Let sleeping dogs lie

(A) To let somebody sleep

(B) To fall sick intentionally

(C) Leave an existing situation as it is

(D) To care for the pet

Q.16

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A cage made for birds. OR A place for keeping the birds in a confined space.

(A) Aquarium

(B) Apiary

(C) Aviary

(D) Arena

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Repulsive

(A) Attractive

(B) Reliable

(C) Disgusting

(D) Uniform

Q.18

Select the option that rectifies the spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence. The “sergent” brought in a lot of changes as soon as he was given charge.

(A) seargeant
(B) sergeannt
(C) sergant
(D) sergeant

Q.19

The given sentence contains an error. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error. The boy told his mother that he saw the most tall giraffe at the zoo.

(A) The boy told his mother that he saw the tallest giraffe at the zoo.
(B) The boy told his mother that he saw the most taller giraffe at the zoo.
(C) The boy told his mother that he saw the most tallest giraffe at the zoo.
(D) The boy told his mother that he saw the more taller giraffe at the zoo.

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Call the shots

(A) To be a follower that makes less important decision
(B) To be in a position to make decisions that influences a situation
(C) To be in a powerless position that follows orders
(D) To be in a neutral position

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. That evening we sat in the courtyard of the hotel once more, (1) _____ the sun sink below the western isles. I told Alexi what had happened that day. I (2) _____ I could glimpse the grey stone wall of Lismore House (3) _____ its island hilltop, the red light of the setting sun glinting from the windows, and from there the wasted frame of Jonathan Blake gazing out across the sea, on nothing, his boy waiting for him to die. But it was my (4) _____, simply the image on my mind, like the image burned on to your eyes when you have (5) _____ too long at the sun, the passing footprint of a creature long gone.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) watching
(B) wallowing
(C) risking
(D) practising

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. That evening we sat in the courtyard of the hotel once more, (1) _____ the sun sink below the western isles. I told Alexi what had happened that day. I (2) _____ I could glimpse the grey stone wall of Lismore House (3) _____ its island hilltop, the red light of the setting sun glinting from the windows, and from there the wasted frame of Jonathan Blake gazing out across the sea, on nothing, his boy waiting for him to die. But it was my (4) _____, simply the image on my mind, like the image burned on to your eyes when you have (5) _____ too long at the sun, the passing footprint of a creature long gone.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) fancied
(B) groped
(C) imbibed
(D) translated

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. That evening we sat in the courtyard of the hotel once more, (1) _____ the sun sink below the western isles. I told Alexi what had happened that day. I (2) _____ I could glimpse the grey stone wall of Lismore House (3) _____ its island hilltop, the red light of the setting sun glinting from the windows, and from there the wasted frame of Jonathan Blake gazing out across the sea, on nothing, his boy waiting for him to die. But it was my (4) _____, simply the image on my mind, like the image burned on to your eyes when you have (5) _____ too long at the sun, the passing footprint of a creature long gone.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) off
(B) on
(C) aside
(D) for

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. That evening we sat in the courtyard of the hotel once more, (1) _____ the sun sink below the western isles. I told Alexi what had happened that day. I (2) _____ I could glimpse the grey stone wall of Lismore House (3) _____ its island hilltop, the red light of the setting sun glinting from the windows, and from there the wasted frame of Jonathan Blake gazing out across the sea, on nothing, his boy waiting for him to die. But it was my (4) _____, simply the image on my mind, like the image burned on to your eyes when you have (5) _____ too long at the sun, the passing footprint of a creature long gone.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) dribble
(B) straw
(C) fantasy
(D) habitat

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. That evening we sat in the courtyard of the hotel once more, (1) _____ the sun sink below the western isles. I told Alexi what had happened that day. I (2) _____ I could glimpse the grey stone wall of Lismore House (3) _____ its island hilltop, the red light of the setting sun glinting from the windows, and from there the wasted frame of Jonathan Blake gazing out across the sea, on nothing, his boy waiting for him to die. But it was my (4) _____, simply the image on my mind, like the image burned on to your eyes when you have (5) _____ too long at the sun, the passing footprint of a creature long gone.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) resumed
(B) rusted
(C) blocked
(D) stared

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(B)**	

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Gujarat

The 2022 FIFA U-17 Women's World Cup, held in India in October 2022, was played at Bhubaneswar (Odisha), Margao (Goa) and Navi Mumbai (Maharashtra); no match was held in Gujarat.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Ayushmann Khurrana

'Cracking the Code: My Journey in Bollywood' was written by the actor Ayushmann Khurrana with his wife, Tahira Kashyap.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Camillo Golgi

Camillo Golgi's 'black reaction', a silver nitrate stain, showed a whole nerve cell with all its branches for the first time; he shared the 1906 Nobel Prize in Medicine with Santiago Ramón y Cajal.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 11000

Kohli reached 11,000 runs in all T20 cricket (internationals, IPL and domestic matches together) in the second T20I against South Africa at Guwahati on 2 October 2022, the first Indian to do so.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Kartik

Guru Nanak Jayanti (Gurpurab) is celebrated on Kartik Purnima, the full moon of the month of Kartik.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Karnataka

Yakshagana, a dance-drama of song, dialogue and elaborate costume and make-up, is the traditional theatre of coastal Karnataka.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Uttar Pradesh

The Bhitargaon temple in Kanpur district, Uttar Pradesh, built of brick in the Gupta period, is among the oldest surviving brick temples in India.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Ramakrishna Mission

Swami Vivekananda founded the Ramakrishna Mission in Calcutta in 1897. The Arya Samaj and the Prarthana Samaj began in Bombay, and Jyotirao Phule's Satyashodhak Samaj in Pune.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Lahori Gate

The Lahori Gate, the Red Fort's main gate, is named for facing towards Lahore; the Prime Minister hoists the flag and addresses the nation from its ramparts every Independence Day.

Q.10 · Answer (D) China

Standard Mandarin (Putonghua) is the official language of the People's Republic of China.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Gross Domestic Product (GDP)

GDP is the value of all final goods and services produced within a country in a period, with depreciation not deducted ('gross'). NDP deducts depreciation, and GNP and NNP count the output of a country's residents rather than of its territory.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Penalty Corner

A penalty corner is awarded in field hockey; breaststroke, backstroke and freestyle are swimming strokes.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Silchar and Porbander

The East-West Corridor runs from Porbandar in Gujarat to Silchar in Assam. Strictly it is not part of the Golden Quadrilateral: with the North-South Corridor it is a separate component of the same National Highways Development Project.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Potassium

Potassium's symbol, K, comes from its Latin name 'kalium', from the Arabic 'qali', the plant ash from which potash was made.

Q.15 · Answer (D) To secure for the citizen, a uniform civil code through the territory of India
Article 44, a Directive Principle, says the State shall endeavour to secure for citizens a uniform civil code throughout the territory of India. The other options are Articles 49, 50 and 48A.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Kitne Pakistan
Kamleshwar received the Sahitya Akademi Award (Hindi) for 2003 for 'Kitne Pakistan', a novel on Partition and its aftermath.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Poona Sarvajanik Sabha
The Poona Sarvajanik Sabha was founded in 1870 by M. G. Ranade, G. V. Joshi and others to put the people's grievances before the government.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Kathak
Roshan Kumari, Shovana Narayan, Maya Rao and Kumudini Lakhia are all noted Kathak dancers and teachers.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Debit cards withdraw money directly from a bank account, while credit cards allow borrowing up to a certain limit.
A debit card draws on the money already in the holder's bank account; a credit card lets the holder borrow from the issuer up to a set credit limit and repay later.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Tamil Nadu
The Constitution (Scheduled Tribes) Order (Second Amendment) Act, 2022, passed by Parliament in December 2022, added the Narikoravan and Kurivikkaran communities to Tamil Nadu's list of Scheduled Tribes.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Brahmaputra river
The Brahmaputra rises in Tibet, where it is called the Yarlung Tsangpo, and enters India in Arunachal Pradesh as the Siang.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Mediterranean Sea
The Nile flows north and empties into the Mediterranean Sea through its delta in Egypt; Lake Victoria is one of its sources.

Q.25 · Answer (B) the duties and powers of the Comptroller and Auditor-General of India
Article 149 deals with the duties and powers of the Comptroller and Auditor-General; the appointment and conditions of service of the office are in Article 148.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) Harmony
A 'feud' is a long, bitter quarrel; its opposite is 'harmony', agreement and goodwill.

Q.2 · Answer (D) because she do not
A singular subject takes a singular verb: 'because she does not'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) he would be late for the lecture
After the past reporting verb 'said', 'will' moves back to 'would', and the professor's 'I' becomes 'he': 'Professor said that he would be late for the lecture.'

Q.4 · Answer (D) Embarass
The correct spelling is 'embarrass', with a double 'r' and a double 's'.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Quick sell out
To 'sell like hot cakes' is to sell very quickly and in large numbers.

Q.6 · Answer (C) is playing
'Will' cannot be followed by an '-ing' form alone. Of the options only 'is playing' is grammatical, the present continuous for a planned event: 'Andrew is playing basketball at the college tournament.'

Q.7 · Answer (B) consecutive
'Consecutive' means following one after another without a break: four fours in a row.

Q.8 · Answer (D) The doctor prescribed some medicine to alleviate my persistent cough, which has been bothering me for days.

Only this sentence spells 'prescribed', 'alleviate', 'persistent' and 'bothering' correctly.

Q.9 · Answer (B) enabled

To 'facilitate' is to make possible; in the past tense the word that fits '___ her to overcome' is 'enabled'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) interviewed numerous individuals, which allow me

'Which' here stands for the whole preceding clause (covering the stories and interviewing the people), so the plural 'allow' cannot be right; with the past 'covered' and 'interviewed' it should be 'which allowed me'. Nor can 'which' stand for 'individuals', as people take 'who'.

Q.11 · Answer (A) harmonium

A musical instrument after 'play' takes the definite article: 'loves to play the harmonium'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) a pirated

'Pirated' means illegally copied, and as it begins with a consonant sound it takes 'a': 'a pirated product'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) the ball is in your court

'The ball is in your court' means it is now your turn to act or decide.

Q.14 · Answer (B) talks

SSC's key gives 'talks': the sentence retells the play in the present ('doesn't like'), so the present simple fits, and the singular 'Demetrius' takes 'talks'. 'Talked' would also be grammatical for one particular past occasion, but the sentence points to none; 'talking' and 'to talk' cannot follow 'the way Demetrius'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Leave an existing situation as it is

To 'let sleeping dogs lie' is to leave a situation alone rather than stir up trouble.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Aviary

An 'aviary' is a large cage or enclosure for birds; an apiary is for bees and an aquarium for fish.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Disgusting

'Repulsive' means causing strong dislike: 'disgusting'. 'Attractive' is its opposite.

Q.18 · Answer (D) sergeant

The correct spelling is 'sergeant'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) The boy told his mother that he saw the tallest giraffe at the zoo.

'Tall' forms its superlative with '-est': 'the tallest giraffe'. 'Most tall', 'most taller', 'most tallest' and 'more taller' are all wrong.

Q.20 · Answer (B) To be in a position to make decisions that influences a situation

To 'call the shots' is to be the one who makes the decisions and controls what happens.

Q.21 · Answer (A) watching

They sat 'watching' the sun sink: 'watch' takes an object and a bare infinitive, as in 'watch something sink'.

Q.22 · Answer (A) fancied

'I fancied I could glimpse' means I imagined I could see, which fits the later 'it was my fantasy'.

Q.23 · Answer (B) on

The house stands 'on' its island hilltop.

Q.24 · Answer (C) fantasy

The writer only imagined the scene: 'it was my fantasy, simply the image on my mind'.

Q.25 · Answer (D) stared

The afterimage comes when you have 'stared' too long at the sun; 'stare' takes 'at'.

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